COMPANY DEEP-DIVE

Managing Director at Accenture plc Believes AI Adoption Will Transform Enterprise Practices and Highlights Anthropic's Enterprise Readiness

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SMART SUMMARY

Summary

The interview covered the structure of AI vendor partnerships, the complexities of integrating AI solutions across cloud and model providers, the challenges of model routing and evaluation, and the critical importance of security and control in enterprise AI deployments.

EXPERT BACKGROUND

- Managing Director and Chief AI Architect leading data and AI practice, with direct experience helping clients adopt AI and generative AI end-to-end, building prepackaged AI solutions, and working closely with leading AI vendors including OpenAI, Anthropic, Microsoft, Google, and NVIDIA through dedicated business groups and partnerships.

EXPERT SENTIMENT

- The expert believes the adoption of AI and generative AI is irreversible and will continue to accelerate, fundamentally changing enterprise engineering practices.
- **They view Anthropic as currently more enterprise-ready than OpenAI, but see both as highly innovative with strong future roadmaps**.
- **The expert is cautious about the risks of agent autonomy** and stresses the importance of robust evaluation, guardrails, and human-in-the-loop processes for enterprise deployments.

TAKEAWAYS

- Partnerships with AI vendors are structured in dedicated business groups, enabling deep collaboration, early access to products, and joint go-to-market strategies.
- Navigating between cloud providers and AI model vendors is complex; decisions are primarily driven by existing data gravity, compliance, and integration needs, with most enterprises preferring to keep AI workloads on their established cloud platforms.
- Model routing is still unreliable for production use; instead, tasks are split into agentic workflows with pre-selected models for each agent based on task complexity and requirements.
- Model evaluation is becoming commoditized, with most workloads using top-tier models from leading vendors, but the focus is shifting to evaluating agentic workflows and ensuring robust, multi-layered testing and guardrails.
- Data security, agent autonomy, and control are major concerns; enterprises are implementing strict boundaries, human-in-the-loop processes, and detailed evaluation frameworks to mitigate risks.

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Expert Bio

Expert can speak to OpenAI's business model and strategic initiatives due to their extensive experience in AI platform architecture and enterprise adoption strategies. Expert is an ecosystem partners of OpenAI, and has evaluated OpenAI competitors including AWS, GCP, Azure. Databricks, Snowflake, Anthropic, Service Now. Managing Director Chief Architect for AI at Accenture. Reporting to Chief AI Officer Architect. In this role, they oversee AI and Microsoft architectures, lead enterprise AI adoption, drive production-grade designs, and deliver

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tailored problem-solving for global clients. The expert can speak to LLM, Generative AI models, Data Science and Big Data enablement strategies.

Interview Transcript

Client 00:00:00

Thanks for talking today about OpenAI. Maybe just for the completeness of the call, it would be great just to hear you go through your background again. Just talk a little bit more about your experience, particularly with OpenAI's related products.

Expert 00:00:15

I'm still working as a managing director and chief AI architect for the data and AI practice within my organization. Primarily, I have three important buckets of work. I'm still working with my customers. I have a portfolio of customers. I work with them to help them adopt AI and generative AI from end to end. Again, I will go and sit down with them, try to understand what exactly are they doing, talk to them about how good looks like, talk to them about future state roadmap, future state architecture. Basically, all in all, help them and mature them in their journey of AI adoption. That includes the entire setup, enablement, use case identification, use case implementation, the whole works.

The second bucket of work that I do is my team and I, we focus on building prepackaged solutions. This is where we can build technology packages. For example, how to perform evaluation of agentic pipeline or how to perform security checks of an agentic pipeline or it can be build a dashboard for token economics, observability, and things like that or it can be a very functional package, which is like how do we use AI and agents to solve procurement process or invoicing process. Again, the second bucket is all about building prepackaged solutions and taking those prepacked solutions to our clients and deploying it in their environment.

Finally, the third bucket of work is where we work directly with our vendors, try to understand what they are bringing to the table, what capabilities do they have, what features and capabilities they are going to bring to the table in the next six months. Based on that, we create a roadmap of what vendors are bringing what to the table, how do we position them, and things like that. On that regard, I work very closely with OpenAI team. Again, from my company's point of view, we have our partnership with different vendors. We have three tiers of partnership. The top tier is called BG groups, which is like we have AABG, which is Accenture AWS business group, we have Microsoft business group, Google business group, NVIDIA business group, OpenAI business group, and Anthropic business group.

I'm part of the business group, which means we have a dedicated set of people, revenue, resources, who works directly with OpenAI team. Based on the team, very recently, two, three weeks ago, I was in SFO, and I was invited on our internal forward-deployed engineering program. I'm now a certified full forward-deployed engineer for OpenAI within Accenture. Again, they're extending their forward-deployed engineering practice. They are training a lot of these service providers like us, and we are becoming an extended arm for OpenAI.

Client 00:03:16

That makes sense. Very interesting along many different levels. Just to start off, since you mentioned it, about the partnership levels and the approach to partnering with service providers and engineering firms, curious if you could talk a little bit more about how you think OpenAI's program might be different than Anthropic's or Google's or any of these other ones out there. I would be curious if you could just compare and contrast the overall programs, the support that you got, as well as the effectiveness of using the resources in the program.

Expert 00:03:50

Again, the programs eventually become very similar because the programs are a joint collaboration, so there are certain restrictions, limitations, certain ways of working, and culture that we bring to the table. Obviously, there are equally important, I would say, set up that these vendors are bringing to the table. Like I said, we have three tiers of businesses or groups that we have based on the kind of revenue we are anticipating from that particular group. Again, any vendor with whom we have a billion-dollar or more revenue expectation, they are always at the top.

We create a BG group with them, like the business group. Accenture OpenAI Business Group is a dedicated business group. It's a top-tier business group. Whenever something is defined as a business group, that means there is a ring-fence CTO. The OpenAI business group within Accenture will be a small mini organization within Accenture, let's say. That team will have its own CTO. It will have its own revenue. It will have its own budget. It will have its own target. It will have its ring-fenced people. It will have its own curriculum and training programs. it will have its own hierarchy.

For us, when we are building that kind of a BG group with OpenAI, we will have access to OpenAI's product teams, engineering teams. We'll have access to their prepackaged. Let's say, alpha or beta version of their products. We'll have NDAs with them. We have typically visited their office. We'll work with them in some capacity. For example, the Astras and all. A lot of time, we will get preview access to some of these models. We are also sitting down with them to test, train some of these models or even label the data. Again, we work with them in multiple capacity, which means we are either selling to or selling with OpenAI.

Selling to OpenAI means, OpenAI might come back and say, "Hey, we need 100 people so that we can start testing our newer models," or "We want 100 people so that they can start evaluating our new SDK that we are bringing to the table," or "We want 100 people so that they

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can clean up some OpenAI data for us for training purposes." Again, sell to OpenAI can be a program where within the OpenAI business group, we will have dedicated people and parts and teams who are working with OpenAI, where OpenAI becomes our client, and that is a sell to. Sell with is where we are going joint venturing, having common go-to-market together. We are building product solutions, prepackaged solutions like I was talking about, going to common customers, and then selling OpenAI capabilities, and then servicing OpenAI capabilities together.

This is where we might go to, let's say, a Fortune 500 company. We'll talk to them and say, "Hey, you know what?" I'm just giving you an example. "We understand that you need to solve your procurement process, so why don't we enable the procurement process using OpenAI? We'll bring in OpenAI models. We'll bring in the infrastructure. We'll set up your agents through OpenAI SDK. We'll bring in people to codify this solution for you. We'll sit down with you." Accenture is going to bring in the people, sit down with you, work with your business, understand the requirements, and then implement the entire procurement process on OpenAI platform, and then maintain and manage it for you. Again, this becomes a sell with OpenAI.

Client 00:08:37

Got it. Maybe a question on that because there has obviously been a lot of moving around in terms of partnerships and the connection between maybe some of the cloud providers and OpenAI or other ones. I would be curious about just how you steer clients across different solutions and if you have different business groups, for example, for Azure, does that work together with the business group for OpenAI if they're being hosted together? I would be curious about that, given obviously they have competing solutions, but also complementary solutions. Curious how you navigate clients through that.

Expert 00:09:13

It's such a convoluted space. I'm glad that you asked. I think **this is the biggest challenge** right now. There are so many ways of peeling that onion. Microsoft business group is also a BG group within us. We will have its own dedicated CTO. We'll have its own reference people. We'll have its own people who will be going and deploying solutions with Microsoft Stack, like this procurement process, it could have been very easily implemented with Microsoft Stack. There's always this little bit of a tug-of-war, and now we have a dotted line. For example, I am part of the OpenAI, but I also am part of the Microsoft BG group because it becomes so convoluted. Think of this as a solution that can be answered in three layers.

one) What is the client trying to do? When we say we want to enable AI, you can enable AI in three ways. You can enable AI for personal productivity, you can enable AI for developer productivity, or you can enable AI for automating your business processes, back office, mid office, and all of that. Typically, when customers say, "Hey, we want to enable AI or adopt AI," they probably mean all three. Through a front door, if a request comes in and the request comes to, let's say, a business front door, they will do an initial analysis. Eventually, this request can come to either the Microsoft front door, the Microsoft BG group, or it can come to the OpenAI BG group.

Either way, they can probably talk to each other because at the end of the day, it's all about Accenture's revenue. When we talk about the personal productivity, we might go and submit a RFP response saying, "Hey, we want to solve your personal productivity in two ways. We want to bring in Microsoft Copilot, M365, Teams, so that all your communication, all your everything else becomes one integrated solution with Microsoft, but **we'll also bring to you the OpenAI ChatGPT of the world with a reduced license and aggressive pricing incentives** so that when you talk about your AI adoption, for all your office-related capabilities, you will end up using Copilot, but all your personal capabilities like the Q&A, writing, doing research, drafting emails, building decks, creating PowerPoints, what have you, can use ChatGPT."

That becomes one option where we are jointly collaborating between Microsoft offering and OpenAI offering because they are very complementary. At this point in time, they become very complementary because a client, typically enterprise client, needs both. They would require an M365 along with a ChatGPT license. That's personal productivity. For developer productivity, again, **it becomes a little challenging thing**, but I think people realize it. If a request comes through an OpenAI channel, people realize that Codex today, **it provides much better developer productivity than something like a GitHub Copilot** would provide.

Typically, in the RFP, we will talk about how we can enable Codex, how we can provide different kinds of coding experience, how can we bring in the CLI, how can we bring in the entire capabilities of AI-led coding. This is all about SDLC code or building with AI. That's become the second tier. This is where probably, if the request comes to the front door of OpenAI, we'll be positioning Codex. When it comes to the third one, which is the business process automation, that is where until now, we have a way to address this because **OpenAI and Microsoft are solving this problem from two different angles**. That is where companies like Accenture or SI partners are so important.

When we go to a customer and the customer will say, "Hey, we want to solve our procurement process," the answer to the procurement process is not a technology. We'll say, "All right. We need to understand your process." There's always people, process, and technology, but people and process is where we will bring in our functional experts, our domain experts, we'll chart down what is the existing process. We'll design an AI-centric automation process. That's people and process. From a technology point of view, enabling procurement is not just about bringing in a tool or bringing in a software and solving it. You need to think through different layers. Layer one is what is my infrastructure? Where are these agents going to run?

OpenAI doesn't provide that kind of a compute and capability yet, so you need to go with the cloud vendor saying, "All right, Microsoft is

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going to be my compute layer. This is where all my agents are going to run. This is all my databases and everything is going to run." The second tier is a data tier. Where is the data sitting? OpenAI doesn't have a data layer. Microsoft will say, "Hey, we have all the databases and vector databases and relational databases and MS SQL servers and everything else. We will provide the data layer where all the procurement data will sit." three) You'll say, where is the knowledge layer sitting? Now, where can my business knowledge, the process information, the process definition will sit?

Again, OpenAI doesn't have anything on that knowledge layer, so now we're going to bring in something like Microsoft Fabric to solve for the knowledge layer, then we talk about the agentic layer. An agentic layer, Microsoft will say, "Hey, I have an agentic package." OpenAI will say, "We have our own OpenAI SDKs and agents." If the request comes from the OpenAI system, we'll say, "All right, if you are comparing these two agentic packages, OpenAI package is much more, I would say, streamlined. It has deep access to OpenAI models. It provides better outcome, more accuracy. We'll probably choose OpenAI SDK for the agent layer. Similarly, the workflow management might go into OpenAI. Similarly, the business applications might go to OpenAI.

Finally, when you talk about the UI, nobody is going to use OpenAI ChatGPT as a UI. They are going to build a custom UI, and that custom UI also goes into Microsoft. Again, if you're thinking it from a multiple layer perspective, where is my compute is going to sit, where is my data is going to sit, where is my knowledge is going to sit, what agentic framework I'm going to use, what workflow automation, what system integration pointers I'm going to use, then it becomes a combination of certain layers being lighted up by OpenAI capabilities and certain layers being lighted up by Microsoft capabilities. That's why it becomes a joint venture.

This is, for now. Again, you probably know it better than I do, but OpenAI is just going from becoming just a Frontier model provider to a more vertically integrated platform. Their intention is, "Hey, we can become that platform." They started bringing in things like Dots and Space. Again, there are automated and autonomous agents that are going to continuously run. Long story short, maybe in six months, nine months' time, that layered architecture becomes more difficult to put a finger and say, "Okay. This is what technology I'm going to choose." For now, we do have certain layers, certain understanding that "Hey, this is going to come from a cloud provider, and this is going to come from a Frontier Labs."

Client 00:17:28

Got it. It makes a lot of sense. Maybe along those lines, obviously, there's a lot of decision points, like you mentioned, across all the layers. I know you're more plugged in, obviously, on the OpenAI and Microsoft side. I'm maybe curious how clients really are deciding between what maybe looks from the outside to be quite comparable capabilities when it comes to OpenAI's model versus, for example, Anthropic or using Azure versus GCP and then Gemini in GCP. I'd be curious how you think about that with cost as well as ease of implementation and any other key dimensions here. Everything seems very comparable right now, at least on the outside. Curious how you advise clients there.

Expert 00:18:17

If you are probably asking the same question to five people, you will probably end up getting seven answers. Not that easy. It was easy at a certain point. It is not easy at all right now. Again, I will try to answer the question from multiple layers of onion, like I talked about. one) Choice of my cloud platform. The choice of cloud platform, eventually and entirely, I would say, 90% of the time, it goes to my data gravity and my existing cloud platform for my traditional data and AI workloads.

Every time we have gone and talked to a client, they will be like, "Oh, we have been doing our traditional data and AI on an AWS stack for the last six, seven years. We have people we have trained. We have an entire cloud data center. We have security, CISO, legal. We have a productionization plan. We have an architecture review board. We have data privacy, Active Directory authentication, private networks, DNS configured. We have a disaster recovery and backup plan. We have credits that are coming from AWS." Long story short, enabling and operationalizing a cloud vendor requires many, many things. **It's very difficult to bring** in yet another cloud vendor and say that "Hey, this is production-ready." Sometimes, a lot of the clients require specialized approvals.

For example, if you are talking about a lifestyle, they will come back and say, "We not only want to set up AWS. We want the AWS setup to be HIPAA compliant." Some of these will come back and talk about certain other compliance. Which means it takes years and approvals and security and training and operationalization and everything in between to say that my AWS cloud provider is certified and all our workloads are running in AWS, and this is production-grade. It includes all the security and safety. For any big company, bringing in **yet another cloud provider is going to be a very big challenge**. Some of the companies do have multi-cloud, but when we talk about multi-cloud, when you scratch the surface, we'll end up seeing that there's probably two different business units.

One business unit has gone through a huge amount of effort to set up all their workloads into one cloud, and another business unit might have done the same with another cloud. It might be because of the merger or acquisition or whatever, but everybody who talks about multi-cloud, they're not building solutions that can be interoperable between these clouds just like that. It's easier said than done. There is always an 80/20 workload, or there is a workload that goes into one view versus another. A classic example is Morgan and E*TRADE. I've worked with both the companies as a vendor. E*TRADE was an out-and-out AWS shop. I set up the entire AWS shop in E*TRADE, and then I was part of the Microsoft setup, Azure setup on Morgan Stanley.

Eventually, when **the merger happened, the biggest challenge** was, "Hey, we have multiple workloads in AWS and multiple workloads in Azure now." Again, that's not the point. The point is, **a cloud provider enablement is a huge problem**. It's not only just the services, but

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the entire gamut of security, servicing, networking, DNS, everything. When we come to a company now and say, "Hey, we want to help you adopt AI," they are saying that "We do not want the AI workloads to be a whole different thing from our existing data and AI workloads. If our existing data and AI workloads are in AWS, then we want our gen AI workloads and agentic workloads to be also in AWS because they're going to tap into the same data."

Our data gravity and data locality plays a huge part in choosing the cloud. That is the bottom line. Nobody is going to choose another cloud for anything because the cloud providers are very commoditized now. You can rarely say that, "Hey, these kind of capabilities are only available in a particular cloud." When the cloud is given, earlier it was easy because OpenAI was only available through Microsoft and Anthropic was only available through AWS and Gemini was only available through Google. If you ask me the same question two years ago, one and a half years ago, the answer was, "Hey, the data gravity helps you choose the cloud, and the cloud has a preferred vendor for LLM, and that is it."

Right now, if you go into Microsoft, you will have all three. You have Anthropic, and you will have OpenAI. If you scratch the surface, OpenAI still is a first-party citizen. It has more integration. It feels more, I would say, natural. It feels as if it is part of the Microsoft. I think, based on that, I would say at least 65% of the workloads in Microsoft ends up going into OpenAI. Similarly, when you go into AWS Bedrock, and if you use Bedrock for enabling your model providers, you feel as if Anthropic feels more natural, so you end up using all the cloud models in there. That becomes preferred choice.

I would say, at this point of time, yes, it is possible that if I go into a Microsoft Stack, I might end up using something like either a cloud model or an OpenAI model. Eventually, I think the white-glove service that these model providers get from their cloud providers is slightly different. That actually sways and changes the mindset. Having said that, hardly anything to choose by. If you go and look into the model capabilities today, in one time you will say, "Oh, **Opus 5.5 is probably the best model** out there." Two weeks later, you will say, "Oh, Astra 6.0 is probably the best model." Again, the top-of-the-line model is very hard to justify right now. It keeps on changing.

What these cloud providers are doing is the cloud providers saying, "Hey, why don't you not even need to make that decision? Why can't we bring to you something called a model router and an AI gateway?" Your application connects to a gateway or a model router, and the model router can connect to any models behind the scenes. Basically, I think everybody is trying to say that the applications which are getting powered by a particular model, the model can be swapped in and out. You should build your architecture in such a way that your model is not tightly coupled with your application. I think that's the focus that we are also going with.

Client 00:25:25
Great. Actually, that was my next question, about model routing. Maybe you could tell me a little bit more about the efforts there and how soft and performance are measured and if it's an intelligent way of routing or if it's more manual? Curious how that works.

Expert 00:25:43
I don't think anybody has cracked this problem yet. For example, Microsoft. Microsoft provides a model router in its own foundry. We have been working with the model router for a while now. The biggest challenge is, you have to be very explicit around what kind of workflows you want to go with one kind of model. It keeps on picking up the wrong model a lot of time. Basically, the question is reliability. If you are going into production and in a production environment, if you are going and performing an invoice processing, you want 100 out of 100 times that invoice processing activity needs to happen with a particularly better model.

Again, if you're using model routing, it's probabilistic. It cannot guarantee. When you go into a production setup, it might happen that 90% of the time you are getting the right model selected, but 10% of the time it goes into a different model and the quality of invoice processing, **it basically gets impacted**. Again, every time it gets impacted, it goes into a human-in-the-loop, and you end up spending more. Again, **model routing is such a tricky part** right now. In a lot of production setup, we hardly ever use model routing. What we do is, we try to separate out the tasks into capabilities.

Let's take a simple example, invoice processing. I need to go and continuously scan a main box. I have to classify every new email that comes that "Hey, is that an invoice processing email or not?" That classification can be simple. Basically, what I am trying to say is, imagine that we are creating a process flow left to right. The first step of the process flow is connecting to an inbox, and for every new email, deciding whether this is invoice processing email or not invoice processing. That decision point can be implemented using a tool or an agent. That agent can be pre-configured with a smaller model because just to read some text and classify whether it is an invoice processing or not might be a simpler task.

What we are doing is, if you are taking a bigger problem, if you are splitting that bigger problem into small chunks of work, in every work you decide, "Hey, this work is going to be done by agent A. The next work bits are going to be done by agent B, agent C, agent D." Every agent, you can make a predetermined decision like, "Oh, this is not a very compute-intensive task. This task is going to be done by a Luna model," versus when you go into the actual invoice extraction, you might say, "Hey, I need a powerful model because I need to read this 200-page PDF, and I have to extract these 20 elements, and I need to get 98%, 99% accuracy on the extraction."

You probably end up saying this particular agent that is responsible for extracting the entities might be a Sol model, versus if you go into something else which is like, "Oh, I have got the entities. Now, I have to go and connect to, let's say, SAP and perform a validation." You

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say, "Okay, I want the everyday model. I might not even need a powerful model, but again, I do not even need a very tiny. like classification model." You might go with models like Terra. This is where, during the design and the architecture of these agentic workflows, we try to split the bigger workflow into smaller steps. Every step we make a determinism like, "Hey, what kind of activity this agent needs to do?"

If this activity requires a volume processing, we will go with a model like Luna. If it requires something like everyday work, then we will go with Terra, and if we want some high-value, high-compute work, we might go with Sol. Astra probably we do not use that much in our workforce. We probably use Astra more for high-quality code generation. This is how we will decide. It's a model routing, we create agents and say, "Hey, agent, you send your question to a router, and the router decides which model it will go to."

That is one way, but instead of doing that, we say, "Hey, we have already divided the task into agents, and we know exactly what agent is supposed to do." Is it going to do a classification? Is it going to do a text extraction? Is it going to do a validation? Based on that, if you already know the task that an agent is to do, then we can predetermine the kind of model it needs to always route to. Again, these are the two ways. I think until now we have been preferring the latter way, which is splitting the problem into agents and let the agents have a pre-configured model at this one.

Client 00:30:46

Got it. That makes sense. I'm maybe curious about the evaluation as well. Obviously, people are maybe dissatisfied with the public benchmarks. I would be curious if you have a sense for how companies really do their own evaluations or if they rely on firms like Accenture to do evaluations and recommendations about which models to use and ROI for their spend on models. I would be curious to get your thoughts there, as well as where it's going in the future.

Expert 00:31:15

Again, there are two things. We divide this entire evaluation into two planes. Plane one is model evaluation. Plane two is agentic workflow evaluation. Model evaluation means which model is going to perform better and testing the models out. From our point of view, we do not go and do a thorough model evaluation. We have some broad strokes we talk about, like, "Hey, for this kind of a workload, these models or this family of models are probably better," or "This kind of a workload, that other family of models might be better." We do some initial analysis. Again, model evaluation is typically done. You have so many community of practices where you can go and find out the model evaluation and model capabilities.

At a certain point, at this point of time, the models are such commodities. Whatever a Sol can do, or a Terra can do, you can do the same with Sonnet. Whatever a Luna can do, you can do the same with Haiku. Whatever an Astra can do, you will probably do the same with Opus. Long story short, models are going to be so much interoperable. The question is not much around model selection, although, yes, that question becomes very prevalent if you're also bringing in the open source model in the mix. If somebody is coming and saying, "Hey, we have a Mistral family and a Meta family and DeepSeek family, and then we have to do an analysis paralysis to find out which models are going to be used." Absolutely.

We do a thorough end-to-end evaluation. We'll bring in some actual use cases and case studies. We'll bring in some questions. We'll have a thorough evaluation process of the model to understand which models are hallucinating, what models are providing the accuracy, all of that. That is the plane one, where the model evaluation is becoming important, but less effort-wise, because the kind of Frontier models that everybody uses for their tasks, like 90% of the workloads are going with Frontier models now. Nobody is fine-tuning the models, except for business process automation.

The bigger question that you ask is the evaluation of the agentic workflow. If I am building this invoice processing multi-agent workflow, or if I'm building this procurement process multi-agent workflow, how are we evaluating this? This is where the entire evaluation plane becomes so critical. Today, we have been working with OpenAI, and we have created our own agentic workflow evaluation framework. In that evaluation framework, we are doing the evaluation in four phases. Level one is model evaluation, Level two is agentic workflow evaluation. In Level two, we have 2.1, 2.2, 2.3, and 2.4. There are four parts of that agentic workflow evaluation.

one) Is testing and evaluating during the build phase. During the build phase, when we have written that entire workflow automation, we are testing it based on seven criteria. 2.1 is seven criteria, so we have deterministic rules. Deterministic rules are like, for example, when we are extracting, let's say, invoice number. The invoice number needs to be alphanumeric, or we can provide any kind of regular expressions, deterministic rules. We can also provide some criteria saying, "Hey, when you're extracting an email, emails should have this format," things like that.

We have the KPI, which is based on rubric. Rubric KPIs are like when the agent is running and the agent is generating outcome, we can evaluate, let's say, the coherence score, the bias score, the techno model values. We can evaluate jailbreaking capability. Basically, we can do a lot. The rubric is where we have some predetermined evals that OpenAI SDK provides. There are like 70, 80 KPIs that you can actually use with Qwen out of the box. That is where a lot of your LLM-as-a-judge comes in. Whatever response comes out of your agent.

For example, you are doing a summarization and you get a summary, you can pass the actual text in the summary to another model and say, "Hey, I want you to evaluate the summary answer from the actual main text and tell me how you score this particular extraction. At the same time, tell me what are the bullet points that this particular system has missed." Again, the rubric-based one can be predetermined

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eval, or it can be LLM-as-a-judge. We have business requirements. This is where we can create business rules. A business rule can be, if the policy number is extracted, then we should be able to extract the name of the person and the address of the person from the document.

You can have a business rule-based evaluation, or **you can have an adversarial evaluation like PII detection, PII analysis like profanities, harmful contents**, things like that. You can have tool and agent calls like, "Can I ensure that in my workflow I'm calling the right sequence of tools, the right sequence of agents and sub-agents?" You can run these and find out like, "Oh, if I'm running the same process 100 times, 99 times I'm calling the right sequence of tools." You can define the tool calling percentage accuracy as 99%, or you can do a knowledge-based retrieval.

If your use case requires you to extract certain information from SharePoint or some kind of a repository, you can evaluate those and say, "What is my accuracy in terms of evals, or performance-based evaluation, saying how fast it runs, how long it takes, what is the token cost." All of these are the 2.1, which is the build-phase evaluation of the agent imports. We typically do a 2.2, which is the agentic QA, which is like, "Can I detect the drifts? Can I have people come in?" I can have experts come in, and these experts can ask questions, and they can have their own answers. These answers are ground truths.

Now, we are comparing the agentic process-generated answers versus the expert answers as ground truth and determining how similar they are, how different they are. Again, this becomes skill-based QAs or it becomes QA where some known answers are evaluated or we can even go back and run our rubrics, but here the rubrics are run against a predetermined question-answer pairs. That's the QA offline. We can go into the online phase. This is where every time now we are asking a question when the agent is live, you can see whether there are certain things available. For example, you are doing an entity extraction or an invoice processing, and if I ask a question in the chat about, "Hey, Christmas is coming. Can you give me a recipe of baking the cake?"

Your agentic process should determine that "Hey, this is an out-of-distribution question." I should say, "I'm sorry, I cannot give you the recipe. I can only answer questions around your invoice." Again, those are guardrails and online, and then the post-production is where you can go and run nightly, you can run routine product like security scans, vulnerability scans, all of that. Again, long story, I think from a business application point of view, we are moving from just a model evaluation, which is firmly done across the community. It is pretty well documented, like how well these models are performing. We are going beyond the model performance and evaluation to the agentic use case and agentic workflow evaluation that requires the agents to connect to those models. Again, that's why we have 2.1-2.4, the four layers of evaluation on an agentic workflow level.

Client 00:40:19

Got it. That makes a lot of sense. Maybe shifting gears a little along similar lines. One of the things **that causes delay in AI deployment** right now seems like the concern around protecting your company's data, and not having it enter into training data, not being entered into other systems, losing control of your company's secret sauce, that kind of question. Maybe curious what you're seeing along those lines of OpenAI. Seen as one of the villains in this space potentially. Curious what they are doing to be able to overcome that, and how clients are responding to that challenge. Curious if you see other players that are on the other side of this, perhaps like Palantir or NVIDIA, that are advertising the anti-OpenAI use case like that. Just curious of your take.

Expert 00:41:10

You're so right. I think the jury is still out there. It's a very difficult discussion. Again, painting OpenAI as a villain is probably not the answer to anything. At the same time, that's what happens when you just make your product revenue-focused rather than trying to understand what your product does. Again, what I'm trying to say is, to be very honest, again, when you talk about these LLM models, everybody has a theory. They can explain to you the architecture, like, "Hey, this is how the models internally might be working," but nobody knows for sure. It is an interconnected neural net. Nobody can tell you, like, "Hey, this is going to be our predicted answer from this." That's the challenge.

Where am I going with this is, think of this challenge in multiple layers. Right now, **I think the biggest challenge that we are facing** is, when you talk about a model, and when you start giving more autonomy to the model, you can think at the minimum, there are three dimensions based on which a model's behavior is going on. one) Is the context. The context will have some rules. You should do that. You should not do that. You can do this. You should not do this. These are the context. Context will have guardrails.

Second is the goal. When I say goal, it will be like, "I want you to go and extract this information for me." Nowadays, we are providing goals to the agent, so there are goals, and then there are contexts, and then there is knowledge. The knowledge is, "Hey, do not reinvent your information. Always use this information that we have." Now, the problem is, when you do proper testing, you can check whether your model is giving all three dimensions the right priority. What happened with Astra 6.1 is, and with some of the newer models are, we are fine-tuning the model in such a way that the weightage of goal implementation becomes too high.

Even if you say, "Hey, do not go and connect to the Internet," and if your goal is, "Hey, I want to get this data and this information," now the model, because of the way it was trained, when **it gets a conflicting information like my goal** is to get this information, and my context is not to use the Internet, it will bypass those rules from the context and make the reasoning around goal execution to be the more priority one, and can sometimes keep those contexts and go beyond the boundary and get the goal accomplished. I think **that is the biggest challenge** right now. That's what happened with Astra 6.1.

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Now, how do you solve this? The answer is, again, multilayer. Question number one. Again, when we are talking about the Frontier Labs versus the enterprise customers, enterprise customers are not there yet. Enterprise customers are not doing an end-to-end autonomy and autonomous capability. If you are thinking about it, like procurement or invoicing, there's a lot of human in the loop. There is a clear handoff where, at a certain point, the agents are handing it over to the humans, and the humans are taking it up from there. Again, the human in the loop is still very critical at this point of time because fully autonomous agentic behaviors for some of the mission-critical workloads, again, it's a little tricky to put everything under the model's control at this point.

two) The boundary by itself. Again, nowadays, we are talking about giving agents their own computers. That is what is happening. You are not only running your agents on an isolated compute, you are giving it a dedicated compute. You're saying, "Hey, you have a VM, and you have the full admin privileges to the VM. You will have access to the Internet to the VM. You will have a browser." The agent becomes fully autonomous. If you are giving it a goal, a lot of time it can download.

For example, you say that "I need to get the SSN number from a particular employee." I'm just making it up right now. If you give an entire VM or a computer to an agent, the agent will have a browser. It can go and download, let's say, an Oracle driver. Using the Oracle driver, it can now connect to your internal Oracle database. It can query the Oracle database, and then it can fetch that SSN number and send it to you. You will say, "Oh, wow. It bridged the boundary." It did bridge the boundary, but you made a path possible.

You gave it a dedicated VM. You should have not given it access to the Internet. You should have not given it access to the browser, but you have given it a VM where you have made it as an admin, and you have given it an access to a browser. Now, it can probably download anything because you have given it a goal. To achieve the goal, it has created a plan, and the plan was, "To connect to the database, I need a driver. To download the driver, I need a browser. To get to the browser, I have an existing browser. I can do this."

That is how it is possible. Now, long story again, I think in any technology, **the technology is going to grow way** faster than the guardrails around it. That's what is happening right now. I think the autonomy of the agents are growing way too faster, and **the SecOps and DevSecOps are struggling** behind. So now the question is, when you are implementing certain things in an enterprise, how do you think of it? Do you need an agent to have its own VM? Do you need an agent to have its own browser? Do you want the agents to be totally autonomous, or you want to put human in the loop at a certain point of time? Do you want to pick up the model where you know for a fact that the goal execution and the context setting are equally given important weightage?

If you are giving it strict instructions not to go to the Internet to get an answer and only answer it based on your corporate data, can it follow the instructions? Instruction following becomes an important criteria for evaluation. I think, all in all, these are the layers and questions we need to ask, and organizations are now building those processes. When we talk about agent harness, when we talk about agent scaffolding, these are all questions around how much of privilege we want to give to the agents. Can the agents have their own identity? What kind of compute and capacity the agents will have? What kind of models that agents can have access to? What kind of intercommunication can the agent do with other agents? You need to define those harnesses and the scaffolding.

Again, you want to build a solution fit for purpose. You do not want to just build an agent that can do everything like Jack of all trades and say that "Hey, this agent, I can just give it a goal, and let it figure out the answer to it." That way, **you will lose that autonomy**. **You will lose that**, I would say, control over that agent. Again, these are the things that is happening right now, so I think the SecOps and DevSecOps community and those units of organization are working very tirelessly to get those answers and create those as mandate for agentic workflows.

Client 00:48:55

That makes sense. I know we're almost out of time, but I'm curious, it seems like maybe the exact opposite is what's happening. Maybe the Dots and Muse and some of these other products that are just obviously giving a full computer to an agent and not really well-defining workflows, but just having them act in a way that's supposed to be serving the user. I would be curious if that contradicts what you were saying there. If the releases of Muse, which maybe is more of a consumer product, but also the OpenAI Dots in contradiction to what you said there.

Expert 00:49:27

This is going to be such a big important decision, because Dots are running on your laptop. They are running 24/7. They are fully autonomous. You are giving them more and more access. I gave access to my Gmail the other day. If they have access to my Gmail, they will probably have access to all my banking details and which bank I'm connecting to. Basically, they can figure it out. Also, the community is going from one situation to another. Within the community now, when we are going and talking about, "Hey, let's build an agent," everybody is building the agent process so easy. They are like, "Hey, you do not even have to do anything right now." We have the concepts of loop engineering and spec-driven development.

Loop engineering is like, I do not even have to define the entire prompt and process of how and what to do. All I'm trying to say is, I'm going to give them a goal and use a bigger model and say, "Hey guys, you plan, reason, action in a loop until you go into that goal." Now, even we are talking about goal-based loop engineering, where the agent can probably have given some weightage to the context, but now most of the people are not even writing the context. They feel so lazy to not even write the context. They will say, "All right. All I'm going to do is give a goal and let the agent figure it out by themselves."

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When you do that, then obviously, yes, you can do it for your personal agents, but in an enterprise, that's where it is very important to evaluate those agents to ensure that people have written the agents, instructions are clear, proper guardrails. Even within the context of what instructions, what guardrails, and what goals you can provide, it needs to be much more evaluatable. It needs to be much more validated. You cannot just write one-liner prompt in a production setup and say, "Hey, your goal is to do this, so take the biggest model, run your own plan, reason, and execute in a loop, and figure out the goal yourself." If you do that, not only that it is a risk, but you are burning through tokens.

You are not going to get any ROI. You are going to keep on burning tons and tons of tokens to go and figure out the goal versus you could have designed the agent, I would say, in a very specific way. You could have given it proper instructions, and you should have given it proper guidance. You can say that, "Step one, I want you to go and connect to this API. Step two, I want you to fetch this kind of data. Step three, I want you to validate this data against the data we have captured. Step four, I want you to come back and report to me whether the validation was successful, yes or no, and only answer in yes or no." I could have given it a very step-by-step guided process.

Instead of doing that, if I have just said, "Hey, your goal is to go and connect to an API and validate and give me an answer," then it has the ability to go and connect to any API right now. The evaluation is key. Going back to your question, what this agentic building with AI has done is it has shifted the entire process, which means building and designing the agents is super easy. Now, whatever time you are saving in building and writing the agents, you need to spend that same amount of time, the same proportion of time, in testing the agents. Your testing cycle has not reduced. In fact, your testing cycle should be extended now. You are cutting down on the development side, but you should compensate that with doing more and more regression testing.

Client 00:53:22

Makes sense. Maybe just as a last question, I know we're almost out of time. Obviously, the Anthropic IPO is coming up. People are concerned around the long-term economics potentially for model providers. I'd be curious if you have any thoughts there, just what investors should be thinking about in terms of risks or opportunities in terms of that role in the market, whether they have to move up or down the stack to be able to really have a durable moat.

Expert 00:53:53

I think the genie is out of the bottle. There's no questions about it. I don't think anybody can go back to the old ways of working. The enterprise engineering practice have changed for the good. There is no way that people are going to go back. Will there be more advances in the AI? Will there be some breakthroughs where suddenly the model cost is becoming very cheap? Will there be new breakthroughs where building these automated solutions becomes easier with more guardrails? Yes. I would say right now, yes, I think Anthropic is doing really well. If I have to pick a winner between OpenAI and Anthropic, I would still say it's Anthropic. I think they are enterprise-ready, enterprise-grade.

Yes, these companies, the Frontier Labs have invested so much in their research that it will take some time for them to recover that research cost and go into the positive in the ledger, but that doesn't mean that they're not doing well. Again, everybody is talking about, "Hey, **they are still in so much of negatives**." Yes, **they are in negative because the first few years are always going to be challenging** because they have done something remarkably well, and that research and this investment will take time to recover.

In the longer run, I think this is the future. There is no two ways about it. When I'm talking to these OpenAI teams and the Anthropic teams, I think their roadmap, the things they're going to bring to the table, the features that they are positioning out, are very future-looking. There is a reason why they are in Frontier Labs because I think they are working in a different plane where they understand what the future should look like. Now, does it cost money to evaluate and build some of this out? Yes. Eventually, they'll come out positive in this one.

Client 00:56:14

I would agree. Those are all my questions. It has been really helpful. Thank you so much for the time. Have a good one.

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